Shafique Islam

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Research Interests

Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Education, Public Economics, Development Economics, Immigration, Technological Change

Education

University of Pittsburgh — Pittsburgh, PA
Ph.D. in Economics — 2023–Present
M.A. in Economics

Central Michigan University — Mount Pleasant, MI
M.A. in Economics — 2022

University of Dhaka — Dhaka, Bangladesh
M.S.S. in Economics — 2015
B.S.S. in Economics — 2014

Skills

Methods: Causal inference and applied econometrics: staggered difference-in-differences (Callaway–Sant'Anna), event studies, synthetic difference-in-differences, panel data and time-series methods.
Data: Large-scale public and administrative data: American Community Survey, IPEDS, County Business Patterns, IRS migration data, Lightcast job postings; data cleaning, linkage, and visualization.
Software: R, Stata, Python, SAS 9.4 (Base Programming).

Working Papers

Warehouses and Diplomas: Amazon's Expansion and Local Educational Attainment [PDF]

I study how Amazon's logistics facility rollout affected local human capital, exploiting the staggered timing of Amazon's entry into U.S. commuting zones between 2010 and 2024. Amazon's entry raised educational attainment, particularly bachelor's and master's degrees, as more graduates moved to or stayed in treated areas and students shifted from part-time to full-time enrollment. The effects reflect spillovers: Amazon expanded skilled employment at other firms and raised local demand for college graduates.

Winner, Best Second-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh (2026).

When Samples Shape Significance [PDF]

with Sonia Ale, Lester Lusher, Huda Osman, and Jacob Stenstrom

We replicate findings from 24 papers in top economics journals and re-estimate each result across 40 independent resamples drawn from the same data-generating process. Sampling variation alone can overturn statistical significance, even when the research design is held fixed.

Work in Progress

Automated Verification and the Enforcement of Eligibility Rules: Evidence from Unemployment Insurance

Using the staggered modernization of state unemployment insurance systems across 14 states (2013–2018) and quarterly U.S. Department of Labor data, I find that modernization raised work-search denials per claimed week by about 110 percent. The rise comes from more formal eligibility determinations, not higher denial rates: technology changed enforcement without any change in the law.

Opportunity or Trap? First Jobs and Immigrant Integration in the U.S.

with Gabrielle Toborg

We combine the staggered opening of Amazon fulfillment centers with the quasi-random initial placement of refugees to study whether readily available first jobs lead to upward mobility or to persistent low-wage work, using restricted Census data (LEHD, Numident, and HHS refugee records) through the Federal Statistical Research Data Centers.

Friends, Rivals, and Performance: Evidence from Random Golf Pairings

with Lester Lusher and Jacob Stenstrom

Awards and Fellowships

Social Sciences Doctoral Dissertation (SSDD) Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh	2026–2027
Best Second-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh	2026
Arts and Sciences Graduate Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh	2024–2025
Governor Award, Department of Economics, University of Dhaka	2014
Government Scholarship, Bangladesh	2010

Teaching Experience

Instructor Summer 2026

University of Pittsburgh. Introduction to Microeconomic Theory (undergraduate).

Graduate Teaching Assistant 2024–2026

University of Pittsburgh. Introduction to Microeconomic Theory (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025); Introduction to Macroeconomic Theory (Spring 2026).

Graduate Teaching Assistant Jan 2021–May 2022

Central Michigan University

Assistant Professor of Economics Nov 2017–Jan 2021

Noakhali Science and Technology University. Advanced Macroeconomics, International Trade, Public Finance.

Lecturer in Economics Nov 2015–Nov 2017

Noakhali Science and Technology University. Econometrics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Dynamic Optimization.

Lecturer in Economics Jun 2015–Nov 2015

Bangladesh University of Business and Technology

Pre-Ph.D. Publications

Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2022). A panel data analysis of infrastructure, human capital development, and economic growth: Evidence from ten newly industrialized countries. *American Journal of Economics and Business Management*, 5(8), 177–185.

Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2022). Does external debt affect economic growth? Evidence from South Asian countries. *International Journal of Economics and Financial Issues*.

Rahman, M. R., Selim, M. M. I., Haque, A. U., Smrity, D. Y., & Islam, S. (2019). Examining the effect of exchange rate and overseas employment on remittances: Evidence from Bangladesh. *Theoretical Economics Letters*, 9, 2593–2605.

Sultana, H., Islam, S., Haque, A. U., & Ale, S. A. (2019). Income inequality and economic growth: Empirical evidence from Bangladesh. *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, 10(16), 78–83.

Ale, S. A., Akter, R., & Islam, S. (2018). Remittance inflow and GDP growth: Evidence from Bangladesh, India, and Pakistan. *Asian Economic and Financial Review*, 8(11), 1340–1353.

Hossain, S., Kibria, G., & Islam, S. (2018). Does globalization affect the economic growth of Bangladesh? An econometric analysis. *Asian Economic and Financial Review*, 8(12), 1384–1393.

Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2017). Do the exchange rates of freely floating exchange rate regimes exhibit mean reversion? *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, 8(20), 81–84.

Islam, S., & Ale, S. A. (2017). Examining the effect of expenditure-changing and expenditure-switching policies on real GDP in Bangladesh. *Journal of Noakhali Science and Technology University*, 1(2), 67–72.

Service and Leadership

Noakhali Science and Technology University

Course Coordinator, Department of Economics — Jan 2017–Jan 2021

Assistant Provost, Abdus Salam Hall — Dec 2015–Jan 2021

Adviser, Royal Economics Club — Oct 2018–Jan 2021

Sports and Cultural Secretary, Teachers Association — 2018

University of Dhaka

General Member, Economics Study Center, Department of Economics

Professional Training

Training in Teaching Methods and Techniques — Bangladesh Agricultural University

One-month program at the Graduate Training Institute, sponsored by the World Bank and the University Grants Commission of Bangladesh.

Memberships and References

Member, American Economic Association; Bangladesh Economic Association (2015–Present). References available upon request.

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